E3 Mixed Tenses – Graffiti Warning Poster – Reading, Grammar & Error Correction

Oct 16, 2026 · @Atin

Teacher notes

Entry 3, about 2 hours. Real Hackney shop shutter poster (photo taken October 2026). Project the photo for the lead-in; the worksheet has a typed copy.

Aims

- Recognise and contrast present simple, present perfect, past simple and *will* future in a real text.
- Correct common learner errors (all taken from the poster itself).
- Discuss graffiti, property and threats; write a short notice using all four tenses.

Content warning: the original ends with a strong swear word. The worksheet stars it out. Crop or cover the bottom of the photo if you prefer.

Stages

Stage	Time	What happens
1. Lead-in	10 min	Show the photo. Pairs: Where is this? Who wrote it? Who is it for? How does the writer feel? Have you seen graffiti in Hackney? Is it art or a crime?
2. Vocabulary	15 min	Task 1: match words to meanings. Drill pronunciation: *graffiti, vandalise, property, warning, threat, promise*.
3. Reading	15 min	Task 2: read the typed poster, answer the questions. Check in pairs, then whole class.
4. Grammar noticing	20 min	Task 3: find one or more examples of each tense. Board the table. Concept check: *I have warned you many times* – Do we know when? (No.) Is it important now? (Yes.) *You didn't take my notes seriously* – Finished? (Yes.) *You will pay* – Now or later? (Later.)
5. Error correction	15 min	Task 4: the writer made mistakes. Learners find and fix them. Good confidence boost –

Stage	Time	What happens
		native speakers make errors too.
6. Controlled practice	15 min	Task 5: gap fill – a calmer notice from the same shop.
7. Speaking	15 min	Task 6: role play – shop owner tells a police officer what happened. Swap roles.
8. Writing	15 min	Task 7: write a polite notice (40–60 words) using all four tenses. Stronger learners: write the graffiti artist's reply.

Discussion point (optional, stronger groups): the writer says "threat is a crime" – then threatens someone. Is this poster legal? What should the shop owner do instead? (Report to the police; use the CCTV as evidence.)

Student worksheet

The poster (from a shop shutter in Hackney – the mistakes are the writer's)

> **TO THE GRAFFITI ARTIST**
>
> This is my last and final warning.
>
> I have warned you many time not to graffiti this shop.
>
> You didn't take my notes seriously. The government & your parents didn't teach you that vandalising someone property is a crime.
>
> Now I will have to teach you a lesson not to mess with the wrong person/people.
>
> I don't make threats, threat is a crime. I make promises. Now you will pay for your actions.
>
> Yours truly, The Punisher
>
> *[Two CCTV photos: 24-09-2026, Thursday, 00:49]*
>
> Watch your back, sleep with one eye open m********r!!!! I have locked on to you, don't say I didn't warned you. Ask yourself, what it worth it????

Task 1 – Vocabulary. Match the words (1–10) to the meanings (a–j).

Word	Meaning
1. graffiti	a. something you own, e.g. a house or shop
2. vandalise	b. be careful – someone wants to hurt you
3. property	c. cameras that film the street or a shop
4. a warning	d. words or pictures painted on a wall
5. a threat	e. be punished for what you did
6. a promise	f. saying "I will hurt you"
7. CCTV	g. damage something on purpose
8. watch your back	h. telling someone about danger, so they can stop
9. teach someone a lesson	i. saying "I will do it" – and you really will
10. pay for your actions	j. punish someone so they don't do it again

Task 2 – Reading. True (T) or False (F)?

1. Before this poster, the writer told the artist to stop. ___

2. The writer is calm and friendly. ___
3. The camera photos were taken at night. ___
4. The writer signs the poster with their real name. ___
5. The writer says it is legal to frighten people. ___
6. The writer thinks the artist was brought up well. ___

Answer the questions.

7. What did the writer leave for the artist before this poster? _____
8. Who, says the writer, should have explained the law to the artist? _____
9. What day of the week was the artist filmed? _____

Task 3 – Grammar. Find examples in the poster and write them in the table.

Tense	Example from the poster	Why do we use it here?
Present simple		
Present perfect		
Past simple		
Future (*will*)		

Task 4 – Find the mistakes. Each sentence from the poster has one mistake. Correct it.

1. I have warned you many time.
2. Vandalising someone property is a crime.
3. Threat is a crime.
4. Don't say I didn't warned you.
5. Ask yourself, what it worth it?
6. *Bonus:* "my last and final warning" – what is the problem?

Task 5 – Gap fill. The shop owner wrote a new, calmer notice. Put the verbs in the correct tense.

> Dear neighbours,
>
> This shop (1) _____ (be) our family business. We (2) _____ (open) it in 2015. Someone (3) _____ (paint) graffiti on our shutter five times this year. Last week we (4) _____ (pay) £200 to clean it. We (5) _____ (not / want) any trouble. From now on, we (6) _____ (report) every attack to the police. Our CCTV (7) _____ (record) the street 24 hours a day. Thank you – we (8) _____ (see) you soon in the shop!

Task 6 – Speaking. Role play.

Student A – shop owner	Student B – police officer
Graffiti on your shop again. Explain: how long it has happened, how many times, what you did, what you will do now.	Ask: What's the problem? How long have you had this problem? How many times has it happened? When did it last happen? Did you see the person? What will you do now?

Task 7 – Writing. Write a polite notice to the graffiti artist (40–60 words). Use all four tenses:

- ☐ present simple (e.g. *This is…*)
- ☐ present perfect (e.g. *You have…*)
- ☐ past simple (e.g. *Last week you…*)
- ☐ future (e.g. *I will…*)

Answer key

Task 1: 1d, 2g, 3a, 4h, 5f, 6i, 7c, 8b, 9j, 10e

Task 2: 1 T · 2 F · 3 T (00:49) · 4 F (signed “The Punisher”) · 5 F (he says a threat is a crime) · 6 F (his parents didn’t teach him) · 7 notes · 8 the government and the artist’s parents · 9 Thursday

Task 3

Tense	Examples	Use
Present simple	This **is** my last warning. I **don’t make** threats. I **make** promises. Vandalising property **is** a crime.	Facts, things always true, habits
Present perfect	I **have warned** you many times. I **have locked** on to you.	Past action, result now; time not given
Past simple	You **didn’t take** my notes seriously. Your parents **didn’t teach** you… Don’t say I **didn’t warn** you.	Finished actions in the past
Future (*will*)	I **will have to** teach you a lesson. You **will pay** for your actions.	Promises, decisions, predictions

Task 4

1. many **times** (plural after *many*)
2. **someone’s** property (possessive *’s*)
3. **A threat** is a crime / **Threats** are crimes (article or plural)
4. I didn’t **warn** you (base form after *didn’t*)
5. **Is it** worth it? (question word order; no *what*)
6. *last* and *final* mean the same – use one

Task 5: 1 is · 2 opened · 3 has painted (this year isn’t finished) · 4 paid · 5 don’t want · 6 will report · 7 records · 8 will see